

Day 6 — Build Session 1

Module: Project Implementation · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will have made substantive progress on their final artefact — by teacher judgement, at least **half** the artefact is in existence by the end of the period.

Materials

- Everything each student needs for their own project (responsibility lies with the student; teacher has a small supply bin for the inevitable forgetters)
- Class supply bin: glue, scissors, sketch pens, tape, ruler, plain paper, cardstock
- Timer at the front (visible)
- Music (optional, low-volume, instrumental — keep it focus-friendly)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (3 min)

- No daily prompt today — we keep this short.
- *“Today is a build day. I am NOT teaching. I’m walking the room. Sit down, take out your sketch and materials, and start. You have 35 minutes. Begin.”*

Core / Activity (35 min) — Quiet build

The bulk of the period is a quiet, focused work session. The teacher walks the room with three roles:

1. **The unblocker.** A student raises a hand because they’re stuck — go over, ask “what’s the next thing you’ll do?”, help them name it, walk away.
2. **The narrower.** A student is trying to do too much. Ask: “If you had to ship by 4 pm today, what would you cut?” Hold them to the cut.
3. **The witness.** A student is working well. Pause for 30 seconds. Note (silently) what they’re doing well. Tell them at the end of class, briefly.

The teacher does NOT teach today. No new content. No “let me show you.” If a student needs a skill, point them at the relevant prior module’s worked example.

Mid-session check (built into the 35 min)

- At the 18-minute mark (halfway), call the room to attention for 90 seconds:
 - *“Hands up if half your artefact will be done by the end of class.”* Note who’s at risk.
 - *“Hands up if you’ve added something today that wasn’t in your sketch.”* Surface emerging ideas.
- Resume.

Wrap-up (7 min)

- 4 minutes — pack up, photograph today's progress.
- 3 minutes — daily journal: > “Today I built: ____ . Tomorrow I will build: ____ . What's blocking me: ____ .”
- Submit journals into the in-tray. Teacher does a quick read; students at risk get a 5-minute morning check-in tomorrow.

Student-facing content

Today is a quiet build day.

The teacher is not teaching today. They're walking the room.

Your job: 1. Sit down, take out your materials and sketch, start within 60 seconds of the bell. 2. Build steadily for 35 minutes. 3. By the halfway point, half your artefact should exist in some form. 4. End-of-class — photograph it. Journal it. Pack up.

Three useful questions to ask yourself when stuck: - *What's the next thing I'll do?* (Names the next action.) - *What would I cut if I had to ship by 4 pm today?* (Forces a priority.) - *Does this match what I sketched?* (Pulls you back to plan.)

Homework

- Finish at home **only what you couldn't finish in class today**. Cap at 20 minutes and stop.
- Bring all materials again tomorrow. Day 7 finishes the build.

Differentiation

- **One tier up:** If you're ahead of schedule, refine — don't add. Iterate on one panel that's already there rather than starting a new section.
- **One tier down:** If you're behind, cut. Pair with the teacher at the 18-minute mark and identify the smallest version of the artefact that still answers your driving question. Build that version.

Teacher notes

- **Don't teach.** This is the hardest thing about today. If you start explaining things, you'll lose the focus the build needs.
- The 18-minute mid-session is your single chance to course-correct. Use it.
- Document each student's progress with a phone photo at end of class. This is your evidence for the documentation rubric and saves the journal from being the only record.
- Project 7 (sustainability audit) students may need to leave the classroom to do their data collection during the build period — check this morning what they need. Allow if they have parental and admin permission to be in a measurement location during class.
- Project 8 (doşa self-study) is *journaling-as-artefact* — these students may be sitting and writing, not making something visible. That's fine; verify they're actually writing.
- Project 9 (multiplication comparison) students should be doing actual timed problems today. Stopwatch in hand.

Common stuck-points (and fast unblockers)

Stuck on	Quick unblock
“My poster won’t fit on one page”	Cut one section. Reload from sketch — which is the most essential section?
“I lost the verse reference”	Open the cache file together for 30 seconds. Find it. Move on.
“My partner isn’t doing their share”	Re-divide tasks for the remaining 30 minutes. Note in journal.
“I can’t draw”	Use traced outlines, photos, or text-only. Skill is irrelevant; clarity is the goal.
“I don’t know how to start”	Start with the <i>easiest</i> element — the title block, one row of a table, one card of a deck. Momentum from the easy part.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- No new citation. Build day.